

3.4 Frequently Asked Questions

When creating reports from *.apvrx files, why do some of the variables that I have checked appear as “Pooled” or as blanks?

When results are pooled, some of the identifying information for individual health impact functions is not carried forward. For example, when pooling incidence results from multiple health impact functions with different study locations, there is no longer a unique study location for the pooled result. So, BenMAP-CE would indicate the study location as “Pooled.”

How do I export my results?

Identify the type of report that you want to create, then refer to the Section 3.3.1 in this chapter on exporting reports.

How do I determine what the Column and Row refer to?

The Column and Row are variables designed to uniquely identify each grid cell in the grid definition. In the case of the County grid definition, the Column refers to the state FIPS code and the row refers to the county FIPS code. One way to get a good sense of the Column and Row variables is to create a map and then view where particular Column and Row variables occur in the map.

Chapter 4

Loading Data

In this chapter...

- Learn how to create a new setup for your project.
- Learn more about the file structure for data inputs.
- Learn how to export and import a setup.

BenMAP-CE can store the information needed to run analyses for a particular geographic area, such as a city, region, or nation, in a single dataset. This dataset is called a "Setup" and consists of 10 categories of data:

- Grid definitions
- Pollutants
- Monitor data
- Incidence and prevalence rates
- Population data
- Health impact functions
- Variable data (socioeconomic variables)
- Inflation rates
- Valuation functions
- Income growth data.

Grouping the data in this way has a number of advantages. It makes it easy to organize and view the data, export the data (either a whole setup or a portion of a setup), and import setups generated by others.

In this chapter we discuss how to add, modify, and delete a setup. It is important to keep in mind that if you delete one part of a setup, you may be affecting other parts of the setup. We discuss this further below.

Fundamental Concept - Setup

A BenMAP-CE **setup** refers to the set of data files that encapsulates all of the data that can be used in BenMAP analyses for a particular geographic area—a city, an entire country, etc. A setup **must** contain at minimum one or more grid definitions for geographic area to which data are assigned spatially (e.g., county polygons or 12 km grid cells); a pollutant definition specifying the exposure season and relevant exposure metrics (e.g., 8-hour max concentration); health incidence and population size data; and at least one health impact function for the defined pollutant in order to run a successful analysis. Setups may also include tables of air quality monitor data; population size and sociodemographic data; economic data; and valuation functions.

Once input into a given setup, these data are available for application in all subsequent BenMAP analyses that use that setup, facilitating future runs.

Modeled air quality data files are not considered part of the setup; they are input into the tool at the time of analysis.

Many users will never need to modify the setup. If you are performing an analysis

Decision Point

When do you need to add or modify a BenMAP-CE setup?

Setups are generally based on a specific geographic area. Hence, you will want to **add** a new setup to analyze a geographic area that is not pre-loaded with BenMAP-CE. Creating a new setup for each geographic area you are analyzing will help you organize the databases you import.

You will want to **modify** an existing setup if a setup already exists for the geographic area to be analyzed but you want to add or change one or more of the datasets (e.g., adding updated population data and new health impact functions to the pre-loaded *United States* setup).

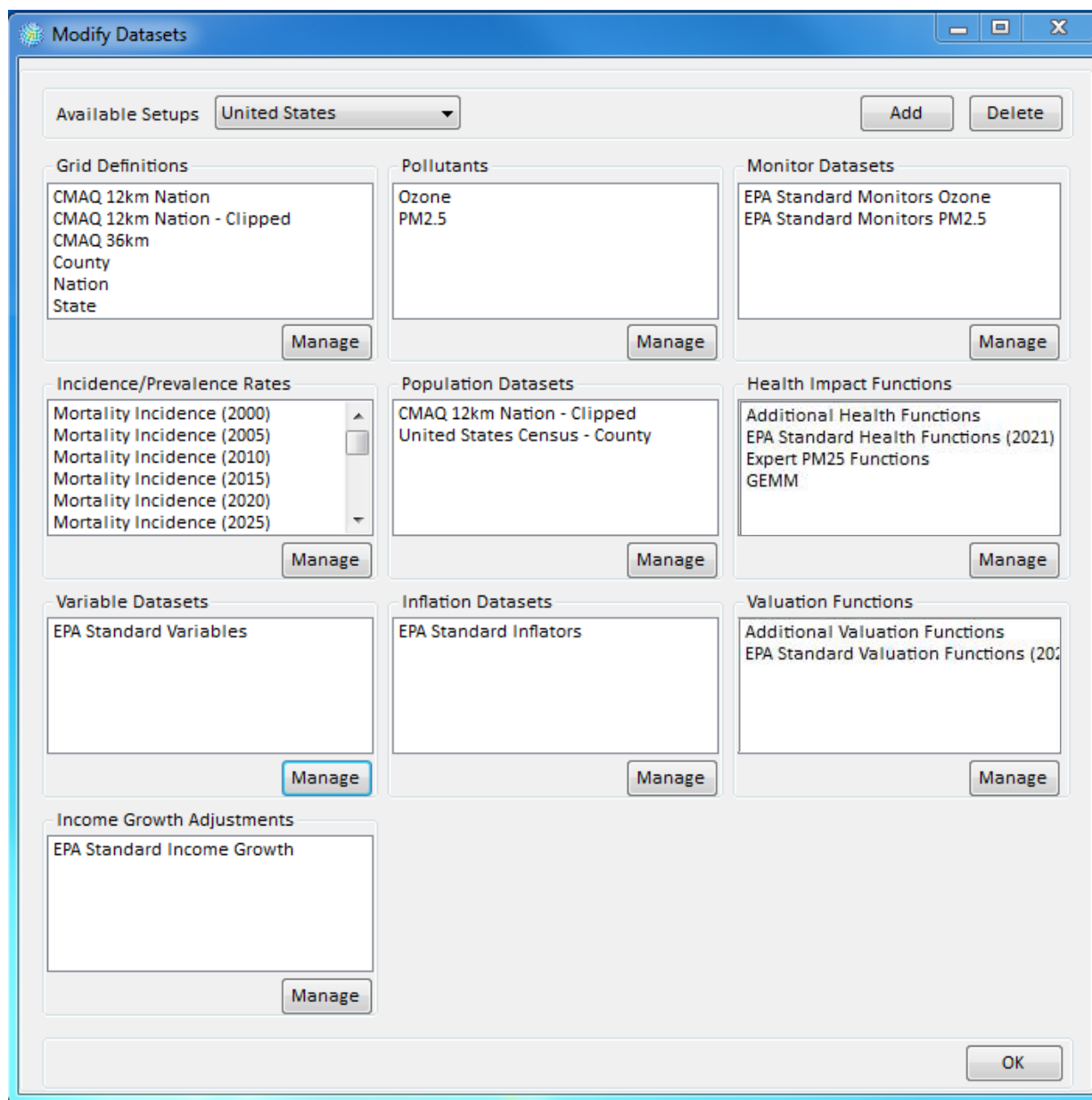
with the pre-loaded *United States, China, or Detroit* setups, you may find that BenMAP-CE contains all of the data you need to perform your analysis, and no additional modifications are necessary.

We will also discuss how to load (import) data into an existing setup. There are a number of steps involved in formatting and loading these data, so it is important to carefully review the steps in this chapter. For most dataset types, BenMAP-CE provides a validation tool to help you check your data file format (column names, required columns, and data types) before import. Validation reports are provided which describe

any errors or warnings with the associated row number and column name.¹³

4.1 Add, Modify, and Delete a Setup

To add a new setup, modify an existing setup, or delete a setup, choose **Modify Datasets** from the menu bar. This will bring up the **Modify Datasets** window. The United States setup, which comes preinstalled with BenMAP-CE, includes a variety of datasets and looks like this:



¹³ Validation reports are saved to C:\Users\\Documents\My BenMAP-CE Files\ValidationResults.